A-A-20127

May 2, 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

HAM PATTIES, CANNED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers cooked, round-shaped, hickory-smoke flavored ham patties packed into hermetically sealed cans requiring refrigerated handling and storage.

Salient characteristics.

The ham patties shall conform to the preparation and processing and finished product requirements as follows. The ham patties shall be canned not more than 30 days prior to delivery. The Department of Defense packing and packaging requirements are contained in the section "For Department of Defense procurements."

A. Preparation and processing. The ham patties shall be prepared from either chopped ham or fresh ham (which is ground and cured during processing) with curing agents, seasonings and optional ingredients as permitted by Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Part 319) of the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA). Ham trimmings may be used provided they contain no excess shank meat, and the fat content of the trimmings is not in excess of 35 percent. Natural oil-based hickory-smoke flavoring shall be added at a minimal rate of 1 ml per pound of fresh meat.

B. Finished product requirements. The ham patties shall conform to the following physical and analytical requirements. Conformance shall be determined by end item examination.

Physical requirements.

No individual patty shall weigh less than 50 grams.

Patty appearance shall be normal for product prepared as specified.

The texture of the patty shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

FSC 8905

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Analytical requirements.

Percent fat shall be not greater than 30.0.

Percent salt shall be not less than 2.2 nor greater than 2.8.

Quality assurance.

When required in the solicitation or contract, the quality assurance of the ham patties shall be determined by the Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), USDA agents. The product shall be examined and/or tested in accordance with the applicable provisions (physical and analytical requirements) in the CID and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation and in accordance with the requirements in the applicable regulations.

End item inspection. The end item lot size, expressed as number of cans, shall be declared to the AMS agent by the contractor. Product from open cans used for product examination shall remain the property of the contractor.

Product examination. Eight filled and sealed cans of finished product shall be randomly selected from the lot, and the contents shall be examined for the defects listed in Table I. Cans selected for examination must be free from damage. The finding of any major defect shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Individual patty weight less than 50 grams.
102	Patty appearance not normal for product as specified.
103	Texture of the patty is dry, rubbery, or mushy.

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1/ Acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (for example: glass, dirt, hair, grease, insect parts, wood, metal) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations (MPIO) employee.

2/ Presence of product evidencing a foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, staggy, or stale) shall cause rejection of the lot.

Fat and salt testing. Nine filled and sealed cans of finished product shall be randomly selected from the lot and distributed as follows:

- Three for laboratory analysis.
- Three for submission to the contractor.
- Three for retention by the AMS agent as a reserve sample.

The three cans for laboratory analyses shall be individually tested for fat and salt contents in an AMS laboratory in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. The lot shall be rejected if:

a. The average fat content of the three cans is greater than 30.0 percent.

b. The average salt content of the three cans is less than 2.2 percent or greater than 2.8 percent.

Analysis of reserve samples at the request of the contractor shall not be permitted unless the original laboratory analysis indicated that the involved lot will be rejected because of noncompliance with the fat or salt content requirement. When the reserve sample is analyzed, the analyses for both fat and salt shall be made and will be considered final. Unused reserve samples shall be returned to the contractor for inclusion in subsequent lots.

Regulatory requirements. The meat component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of USDA. The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace. The delivered product shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The ham patties shall be preserved, packaged, packed, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. The contractor shall select 18 or 22 ham patties to be packaged in each can. Every can shall have the same number of patties. The patties shall be interleaved and be covered top and bottom with parchment paper. The parchment paper shall separate the product from the sides of the can. Each filled and sealed can shall be vacummed packed. Failure of the can to meet the vacuum requirement shall cause rejection of the lot. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer:

A. Commercial packaging. Same as for commercial practices (see Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking).

B. Commercial packing. Twelve cans of product shall be packed in a fiberboard container complying with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the final closure of the box. The cans shall be packed on end, four in length, three in width, and one in depth within the box.

C. Export packaging. The contractor shall select 18 or 22 ham patties to be packaged in each can. Every can shall have the same number of patties. The patties shall be packaged in an open-top style, round metal can, with a soldered or welded side seam and compound-lined, double-seamed ends. The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tin plate. The can shall have a sufficient base plate weight and temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The entire inside area of the can shall be enameled. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to Type I or, when specified, Type III of TT-C-495. The patties shall be interleaved and covered top and bottom with parchment paper. The parchment paper shall separate the patties

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from the sides of the can. Each filled and sealed can shall have a vacuum of not less than 10 inches of mercury at time of closing. Failure of any can to meet the vacuum requirements shall cause rejection of the lot.

D. Export packing. Twelve cans of product shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, grade V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed on end, four in length, three in width, and one in depth, within a container. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

E. Labeling (commercial and export). Labeling of cans shall be in accordance with commercial practice and be in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

F. Marking (commercial and export). Commercial markings for shipping containers are acceptable provided the following information is included:

National Stock Number	Date of Packaging (month/year)
Item Description	Contract Number
Quantity, Unit of Issue	Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor
	Inspection/Test Date

In addition, the following precautionary marking shall appear in letters not less than 1/2-inch high on top of each container:

KEEP REFRIGERATED (35° to 40°F)

Notes.

Sources of Documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
1616 P Street, NW
Washington, DC 20036

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Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists may be obtained from:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists
1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210
Arlington, VA 22209

Sources of governmental documents are as follows:

The applicable regulations of the MPIO, USDA are contained in 9 CFR Part 200 to end. Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. These documents may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specification Unit (WFSIS)
Room 6039
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit request for copies of this CID to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID may be submitted to:

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U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center
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Natick, MA 01760-5014

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

HHS-FDA, NIH, IHS
USDA-MRD
DOJ-BOP
VA-OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-B016

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